

Shadows of the Convergence

A D&D 5th Edition Adventure for Characters Level 2-4

Sequel to "The Whispering Woods"

Adventure Length: 4-5 sessions

Party Size: 3-5 characters

Adventure Type: Investigation / Supernatural Horror / Wilderness Adventure

Themes: Growing power, responsibility, ancient threats, magical corruption

Table of Contents

1. [Adventure Background](#)
 2. [Returning to Millbrook](#)
 3. [The Growing Threat](#)
 4. [Key Locations](#)
 5. [NPCs and Allies](#)
 6. [Investigation and Discovery](#)
 7. [The Ancient Enemy](#)
 8. [Encounters and Challenges](#)
 9. [The Final Confrontation](#)
 10. [Treasure and Rewards](#)
 11. [Appendices](#)
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Adventure Background

Six months have passed since the party helped resolve the crisis in the Whispering Woods. Lyra Reed has been training under Sister Meredith's guidance, slowly learning to control her druidic abilities. The village of Millbrook has returned to prosperity, and the forest has healed from its magical corruption. All seemed well until three weeks ago, when disturbing reports began arriving from the surrounding region.

Villages throughout the area are reporting similar incidents to what happened in Millbrook, but these new disturbances are different - darker and more aggressive. Young magic-users are disappearing entirely, crops are withering despite perfect weather, and strange shadowy creatures have been spotted near sites of magical activity. Most troubling of all, Lyra has begun having prophetic nightmares about an ancient evil stirring beneath the earth.

The Truth Behind the Crisis: The magical disturbance in the Whispering Woods was not an isolated incident. Lyra's uncontrolled power six months ago was part of a larger pattern - young magic-users across the region experiencing sudden awakenings of their abilities. This surge of untrained magical energy has weakened the ancient seals that bind a powerful entity known as the Shadow of the Deep, a primordial force of corruption and decay that was imprisoned centuries ago by the combined efforts of multiple druidic circles.

The Shadow's Influence: As the entity stirs from its prison, it seeks to corrupt or consume the very magic-users whose awakening powers helped weaken its bonds. It sends forth shadowy servants to capture young druids, wizards, and sorcerers, using their life force and magical energy to break free completely. Each captured magic-user makes the Shadow stronger while leaving behind tainted ground that slowly spreads its corruption.

The Convergence: Ancient prophecies speak of a time when "the children of magic shall awaken as one, and in their untested power, loose what was bound in the deep places." This convergence of magical awakenings happens only once every few centuries, and each time, the Shadow of the Deep grows closer to freedom. Only by uniting the young magic-users and teaching them to work together can the ancient seals be renewed and the threat contained.

Returning to Millbrook

A Changed Village

When the party returns to Millbrook, they find a community that has grown in confidence and prosperity. The successful resolution of the forest crisis has brought positive attention to the village, including:

- **New Residents:** A few families have moved to Millbrook, drawn by its reputation for accepting magical individuals
- **Improved Defenses:** The village has organized a small militia and built a proper guardhouse
- **Economic Growth:** Trade has increased, and the village now hosts a weekly market
- **Magical Integration:** Lyra's presence has made magic more accepted and understood

However, this growth has also brought new challenges and responsibilities.

Lyra's Progress

Lyra Reed has made significant progress in her training:

- **Controlled Magic:** She can now reliably cast spells without emotional outbursts
- **Nature Connection:** Her bond with the forest has deepened, allowing her to sense disturbances across the region
- **Leadership Role:** Younger residents look up to her as a protector and guide

- **Prophetic Dreams:** Her growing power has awakened dormant divination abilities

Lyra's Current State:

- **Level:** 3rd level Circle of the Land Druid
- **Personality:** More confident but burdened by responsibility
- **Goals:** Protect her community and help other young magic-users
- **Fears:** That her past mistakes have contributed to the current crisis

The Call for Help

The party's return to Millbrook coincides with the arrival of **Tobias Quill**, the wandering scholar from their first adventure. He brings disturbing news and a desperate request for aid:

Recent Incidents Across the Region:

- **Greenvale:** A young sorcerer vanished three nights ago; crops in a mile radius have turned black
- **Riverford:** Twin wizard apprentices disappeared during their first formal lesson; the river has begun flowing backwards
- **Hillhaven:** A druid initiate was taken by "living shadows"; the entire hillside is now barren
- **Copperhill:** A teenage warlock's magical awakening was interrupted by shadow creatures; the copper mines have gone cold and dark

The Pattern: In each case, young magic-users with recently awakened or developing powers have been taken by shadowy entities. The magical corruption left behind is more severe and lasting than what occurred in Millbrook, suggesting a malevolent intelligence behind the attacks.

Tobias's Discovery: His research has revealed references to an ancient entity called the Shadow of the Deep in fragmented texts from multiple druidic circles. The descriptions match the recent incidents, and the timing correlates with prophecies about magical convergences.

The Urgent Request: Tobias asks the party to investigate these incidents, both to rescue the missing magic-users and to gather information about the entity behind the attacks. He believes that understanding the Shadow's nature and goals is crucial to stopping it before it can break free entirely.

The Growing Threat

The Shadow of the Deep

Ancient History: Centuries ago, the Shadow of the Deep was a powerful entity that fed on magical energy and corrupted natural systems. It was eventually imprisoned by a coalition of

druids, wizards, and clerics who combined their power to create layered seals binding it deep underground. The binding ritual required the willing sacrifice of several powerful magic-users, whose life force became part of the prison itself.

Current State: The Shadow remains bound but has been slowly weakening its prison by exploiting the natural ebb and flow of magical energy. The recent convergence of young magic-users awakening to their powers provided the perfect opportunity to accelerate its escape attempts.

Powers and Abilities:

- **Shadow Servants:** Creates incorporeal minions that can travel great distances
- **Magical Drain:** Absorbs spell energy and magical life force to strengthen itself
- **Corruption Aura:** Taints the land around its influence, killing plants and poisoning water
- **Mental Influence:** Can communicate with and manipulate creatures touched by shadow magic
- **Planar Knowledge:** Understanding of magical theory that surpasses most mortal scholars

Goals:

1. **Escape:** Break free from its ancient prison completely
2. **Consumption:** Absorb the magical energy of the awakened young magic-users
3. **Corruption:** Spread its influence across the natural world
4. **Dominion:** Establish itself as a power that commands fear and obedience

Weaknesses:

- **Light Magic:** Vulnerable to radiant damage and divine energy
- **Natural Magic:** Pure druidic magic, when used with confidence and unity, can reinforce the binding seals
- **Willing Sacrifice:** The original binding can be renewed, but requires significant personal cost
- **Time Limit:** Must break free during the convergence period or wait centuries for the next opportunity

The Missing Magic-Users

Each of the captured individuals has unique abilities that the Shadow seeks to exploit:

Elena Brightwater (Greenvale) - *3rd level Draconic Bloodline Sorcerer*

- **Age:** 17
- **Awakening:** Fire magic manifested during an argument with her parents
- **Personality:** Fiery temper but loyal heart
- **Current State:** Held in a shadow-tainted cave system, her energy being slowly drained

Marcus and Marina Riverstone (Riverford) - *2nd level School of Divination Wizards*

- **Age:** Both 16 (twins)
- **Awakening:** Shared prophetic vision during their first formal magic lesson
- **Personality:** Marcus is cautious and analytical, Marina is intuitive and bold
- **Current State:** Imprisoned together, their twin bond providing some resistance to the draining

Finn Greenthumb (Hillhaven) - *2nd level Circle of the Moon Druid*

- **Age:** 15
- **Awakening:** Shape-shifted into a wolf during a dangerous thunderstorm
- **Personality:** Quiet and nature-loving, communicates better with animals than people
- **Current State:** Held in a corrupted grove, his connection to nature being perverted

Raven Darkbane (Copperhill) - *1st level Great Old One Warlock*

- **Age:** 18
- **Awakening:** Made contact with an otherworldly entity while exploring old mines
- **Personality:** Brooding and mysterious, struggles with the source of his power
- **Current State:** The Shadow is attempting to sever his pact and claim his patron's power

Key Locations

1. Greenvale - The Withered Fields

A farming community known for its exceptional crops until three weeks ago when everything in a mile radius began dying.

The Village:

- **Population:** 150 people, mostly farmers and their families
- **Current State:** Panicked and desperate, crops failing just before harvest
- **Key NPCs:** Elena's parents (Thomas and Sarah Brightwater), Village Elder Henrik
- **Atmosphere:** Fear and desperation, with some villagers blaming Elena for the blight

Environmental Effects:

- **Withered Crops:** All plant life within a mile of the village center has turned black and brittle
- **Poisoned Water:** The village well water tastes bitter and causes nightmares
- **Shadow Presence:** Dark shapes move between the dead plants at night
- **Emotional Drain:** Villagers report feeling unusually tired and sad

Investigation Opportunities:

- **Elena's Room:** Scorch marks on the walls show where her powers first manifested
- **The Blight Center:** The corruption radiates from a specific point near the village well
- **Witness Accounts:** Several villagers saw "living shadows" on the night Elena disappeared
- **Magical Traces:** Detect Magic reveals necromantic and shadow magic residue

Encounters:

- **Shadow Spawn (2-3):** Lesser manifestations of the Shadow's influence
- **Blighted Animals:** Corrupted farm animals that attack living creatures
- **Emotional Challenge:** Dealing with Elena's guilt-ridden and frightened parents

The Hidden Cave System: Following tracks and magical traces leads to a cave system beneath the village where Elena is being held. The caves show signs of recent excavation, as if something dug its way up from deep underground.

2. Riverford - The Backwards River

A riverside trading post where the river has begun flowing in the wrong direction since the twins' disappearance.

The Settlement:

- **Population:** 80 people, mostly traders and river workers
- **Current State:** Trade has stopped due to the river's impossible behavior
- **Key NPCs:** Master Aldwin (the twins' magic teacher), Captain Borris (riverboat captain)
- **Atmosphere:** Confusion and growing fear of magical forces beyond their understanding

Environmental Effects:

- **Reversed Flow:** The river flows uphill, defying natural law
- **Time Distortions:** Clocks run differently throughout the settlement
- **Prophetic Echoes:** People randomly speak fragments of prophecy they don't understand
- **Reality Fluctuations:** Minor illusions and magical effects occur spontaneously

Investigation Opportunities:

- **The Magic School:** A small tower where Master Aldwin teaches basic magical theory
- **The Twins' Shared Room:** Identical belongings arranged in perfect symmetry
- **River Observations:** The water itself seems to whisper in Sylvan when examined closely
- **Prophetic Fragments:** Collecting the random prophecies reveals clues about the Shadow's prison

Encounters:

- **Temporal Anomalies:** Areas where time moves differently, requiring careful navigation
- **Prophetic Visions:** Wisdom saves to interpret helpful but cryptic visions
- **Shadow Wisps:** Incorporeal scouts that attempt to spy on the party

The Sunken Library: The twins are held in a partially flooded underground library that exists in a state of temporal flux. Ancient texts here contain crucial information about the Shadow's original binding.

3. Hillhaven - The Dead Hill

A hilltop community that lived in harmony with nature until their entire hillside ecosystem collapsed overnight.

The Village:

- **Population:** 200 people, including many druids and rangers
- **Current State:** Struggling to understand how their connection to nature was severed so completely
- **Key NPCs:** Druid Elder Senna, Finn's mentor Ranger Captain Dale
- **Atmosphere:** Grief and confusion, as if they've lost a fundamental part of their identity

Environmental Effects:

- **Ecological Collapse:** All plants and animals on the hill have died or fled
- **Unnatural Silence:** No wind, no animal sounds, no rustling leaves
- **Corrupted Earth:** The soil itself has turned gray and lifeless
- **Spiritual Void:** Druids cannot cast spells requiring connection to nature while on the hill

Investigation Opportunities:

- **The Sacred Grove:** Where Finn was taken, now a circle of dead trees
- **Druidic Archives:** Records of ancient threats and protective rituals
- **Animal Witnesses:** Surviving creatures who fled can provide information through speak with animals
- **Magical Resonance:** The hill still echoes with the trauma of its corruption

Encounters:

- **Corrupted Treants:** Once-guardian trees now twisted by shadow magic
- **Despair Wraiths:** Manifestations of the collective grief of the dead ecosystem
- **Nature's Lament:** Emotional challenge requiring characters to experience the hill's pain

The Inverted Grove: Finn is held in a grove that exists partially underground, where corrupted nature magic creates impossible geometries and perverted natural laws.

4. Copperhill - The Cold Mines

A mining town where the discovery of a young warlock's powers coincided with all the mines going mysteriously cold.

The Town:

- **Population:** 300 people, mostly miners and their families
- **Current State:** Economic disaster as the mines have become too cold to work
- **Key NPCs:** Mine Foreman Gareth Stone, Raven's guardian Aunt Miriam
- **Atmosphere:** Industrial pragmatism clashing with supernatural fear

Environmental Effects:

- **Supernatural Cold:** The mines maintain freezing temperatures despite the warm surface weather
- **Otherworldly Whispers:** Strange voices echo from the deepest shafts
- **Metallic Corruption:** Copper veins have turned black and emit a faint, unsettling hum
- **Planar Instability:** Occasional glimpses of alien landscapes through reflective surfaces

Investigation Opportunities:

- **Raven's Workshop:** Where he experimented with otherworldly contacts
- **The Deep Shafts:** Ancient mining tunnels that predate the current operation
- **Mining Records:** Historical documents showing previous unexplained incidents
- **Planar Evidence:** Signs of extraplanar influence mixing with the Shadow's corruption

Encounters:

- **Ice Mephits:** Elemental creatures drawn by the unnatural cold
- **Corrupted Miners:** Workers who stayed too long in the mines and were changed
- **Otherworldly Intrusion:** Brief manifestation of Raven's original patron trying to help

The Abyssal Shaft: Raven is held at the bottom of the deepest mine shaft, where the Shadow is attempting to corrupt or sever his connection to his otherworldly patron.

5. The Convergence Point - The Ancient Prison

The location where all the corruption threads lead, hidden deep beneath the earth.

The Descent: The party must follow increasingly strong magical traces to a hidden entrance that leads down into ancient tunnels. These passages show signs of being carved by multiple different civilizations over centuries, all working together on the same project.

The Prison Complex:

- **The Seal Chamber:** Multiple overlapping magical circles and protective wards
- **The Binding Stones:** Massive crystalline formations that anchor the prison magic
- **The Corruption Source:** Where the Shadow of the Deep writhes against its bonds
- **The Sacrifice Memorial:** Statues and inscriptions honoring those who gave their lives to create the prison

Environmental Challenges:

- **Magical Instability:** Wild magic effects become increasingly common as they descend
- **Shadow Manifestations:** The Shadow's influence creates hostile illusions and creatures
- **Temporal Echoes:** Visions of the past showing the original binding ritual
- **Moral Weight:** The party feels the spiritual pressure of the ancient sacrifice

The Final Chamber: Here the party finds all four captured magic-users suspended in shadow-crystal formations that slowly drain their energy. The Shadow of the Deep appears as a massive form of living darkness, still partially bound but gaining strength with each passing moment.

NPCs and Allies

Returning Characters

Lyra Reed - *3rd Level Circle of the Land Druid Female human, age 16, neutral good*

Six months of training have transformed Lyra from a frightened girl into a confident young druid, though she still carries the weight of responsibility heavily.

- **Armor Class** 12 (15 with *barkskin*)
- **Hit Points** 24 (3d8 + 6)
- **Speed** 30 ft.
- **STR** 10 (+0) **DEX** 14 (+2) **CON** 14 (+2) **INT** 12 (+1) **WIS** 16 (+3) **CHA** 13 (+1)
- **Skills** Animal Handling +5, Medicine +5, Nature +5, Perception +5, Survival +5
- **Senses** passive Perception 15
- **Languages** Common, Druidic
- **Challenge** 2 (450 XP)

Spellcasting. Lyra is a 3rd-level spellcaster. Her spellcasting ability is Wisdom (spell save DC 13, +5 to hit with spell attacks). She has the following druid spells prepared:

- **Cantrips (at will):** *druidcraft, guidance, produce flame*
- **1st level (4 slots):** *cure wounds, detect magic, entangle, speak with animals*
- **2nd level (2 slots):** *barkskin, moonbeam, pass without trace*

Wild Shape (2/Short or Long Rest). Lyra can use her action to magically assume the shape of a beast that she has seen before of challenge rating 1/4 or lower. She can stay in beast shape for 1 hour.

Natural Recovery. During a short rest, Lyra can recover some of her expended spell slots. The spell slots can have a combined level equal to or less than half her druid level (rounded up).

Actions Scimitar. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) slashing damage.

Shield. *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, range 80/320 ft., one target. *Hit:* 4 (1d6 + 1) piercing damage.

Personality: More confident but still empathetic, takes responsibility for others **Goals:** Help rescue the captured magic-users and prevent the Shadow's escape **Role in Adventure:** Guide and magical support, provides crucial knowledge about the Shadow through her prophetic dreams

Tobias Quill - *4th Level School of Divination Wizard Male human, age 45, lawful neutral*

The wandering scholar has continued his research and gained significant knowledge about the current crisis.

Personality: Scholarly, methodical, feels responsible for not predicting this crisis **Goals:** Understand the Shadow's nature and find a way to renew the ancient bindings **Role in Adventure:** Information source and magical research support **Special Knowledge:** Can cast *legend lore* once per day to uncover ancient secrets

New Allies

Elder Senna - *6th Level Circle of the Stars Druid Female elf, age 300, neutral good*

The druid elder from Hillhaven who provides crucial information about the ancient binding rituals.

Personality: Ancient wisdom combined with fierce determination to protect nature **Goals:** Restore the natural balance and prevent the Shadow's complete escape **Role in Adventure:** Provides knowledge of the original binding ritual and its requirements **Special Abilities:** Can cast *commune with nature* to track the Shadow's influence

Master Aldwin - *5th Level School of Divination Wizard Male human, age 55, lawful good*

The twins' magic teacher who feels responsible for their capture during their first formal lesson.

Personality: Guilt-ridden but determined to help rescue his students **Goals:** Rescue Marcus and Marina, improve magical education safety **Role in Adventure:** Provides magical support and knowledge of divination magic **Special Knowledge:** Understands the twins' magical bond and how it might be used to resist the Shadow

Captain Dale - *4th Level Beast Master Ranger Male human, age 40, chaotic good*

Finn's mentor who has been tracking the shadow creatures responsible for the kidnappings.

Personality: Gruff exterior hiding deep care for his students and the natural world **Goals:** Rescue Finn and eliminate the threat to nature's balance **Role in Adventure:** Tracking and wilderness survival expertise **Animal Companion:** A dire wolf named Storm who can sense shadow magic

Investigation and Discovery

Gathering Information

Phase 1: Village Investigations (Sessions 1-2) The party visits each affected community to gather clues about the Shadow's methods and goals.

Key Information to Discover:

- Pattern of young magic-users being targeted during moments of magical awakening or training
- Shadow creatures that can travel long distances and phase through solid matter
- Corruption that spreads from specific focal points underground
- Time pressure - the corruption is accelerating and will soon reach a critical point

Investigation Methods:

- **Interviewing witnesses** about the disappearances and strange phenomena
- **Magical analysis** of the corruption and shadow creature traces
- **Historical research** into local legends and ancient records
- **Tracking** the shadow creatures' paths back to their sources

Phase 2: Underground Exploration (Session 3) Following the clues leads to connected underground locations where the captured magic-users are held.

Key Discoveries:

- The underground areas are connected by ancient tunnels that predate current civilization
- Each location contains part of the original binding magic, now corrupted and weakened
- The captured magic-users are being drained to fuel the Shadow's escape attempt
- Time is running out - the binding will fail completely within days

Phase 3: The Ancient Truth (Session 4) Research and exploration reveal the full scope of the Shadow's prison and the requirements for renewing the binding.

Critical Knowledge:

- The original binding required willing sacrifice from powerful magic-users
- The binding can be renewed, but only during the convergence period
- All the captured magic-users must participate willingly for the ritual to succeed
- The party must choose between a temporary solution and a permanent one requiring great sacrifice

Encounters and Challenges

Shadow Creatures

Shadow Spawn *Medium undead, neutral evil*

- **Armor Class** 12
- **Hit Points** 16 (3d8 + 3)
- **Speed** 40 ft.
- **STR** 6 (-2) **DEX** 14 (+2) **CON** 13 (+1) **INT** 6 (-2) **WIS** 10 (+0) **CHA** 8 (-1)
- **Skills** Stealth +4
- **Damage Vulnerabilities** radiant
- **Damage Resistances** acid, cold, necrotic; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks
- **Damage Immunities** poison
- **Condition Immunities** exhaustion, frightened, grappled, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned, prone, restrained
- **Senses** darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 10
- **Languages** —
- **Challenge** 1/2 (100 XP)

Amorphous. The shadow spawn can move through a space as narrow as 1 inch wide without squeezing.

Shadow Stealth. While in dim light or darkness, the shadow spawn can take the Hide action as a bonus action.

Sunlight Weakness. While in sunlight, the shadow spawn has disadvantage on attack rolls, ability checks, and saving throws.

Actions Strength Drain. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 9 (2d6 + 2) necrotic damage, and the target's Strength score is reduced by 1d4. The target dies if this reduces its Strength to 0. Otherwise, the reduction lasts until the target finishes a long rest.

Encounter: 2-3 Shadow Spawn **Tactics:** Use stealth and mobility to isolate targets **Resolution:** Destroyed by radiant damage or when the Shadow's influence is cleansed

Greater Shadow *Large undead, chaotic evil*

- **Armor Class** 13
- **Hit Points** 52 (8d10 + 8)
- **Speed** 40 ft., fly 40 ft. (hover)
- **STR** 8 (-1) **DEX** 16 (+3) **CON** 13 (+1) **INT** 8 (-1) **WIS** 12 (+1) **CHA** 14 (+2)
- **Skills** Stealth +6
- **Damage Vulnerabilities** radiant
- **Damage Resistances** acid, cold, necrotic; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks
- **Damage Immunities** poison
- **Condition Immunities** exhaustion, frightened, grappled, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned, prone, restrained
- **Senses** darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 11
- **Languages** Common, understands the languages it knew in life
- **Challenge** 3 (700 XP)

Amorphous. The greater shadow can move through a space as narrow as 1 inch wide without squeezing.

Shadow Stealth. While in dim light or darkness, the greater shadow can take the Hide action as a bonus action.

Sunlight Weakness. While in sunlight, the greater shadow has disadvantage on attack rolls, ability checks, and saving throws.

Actions Multiattack. The greater shadow makes two strength drain attacks.

Strength Drain. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 10 (2d6 + 3) necrotic damage, and the target's Strength score is reduced by 1d4. The target dies if this reduces its Strength to 0. Otherwise, the reduction lasts until the target finishes a long rest.

Shadow Spawn (1/Day). The greater shadow creates 1d4 shadow spawn from the corpses of creatures that have died within the last minute. The shadow spawn act on the greater shadow's initiative and obey its commands.

Encounter: 1 Greater Shadow (guarding important locations) **Tactics:** Creates minions while staying mobile and avoiding direct confrontation **Resolution:** Must be destroyed to access certain areas or rescued magic-users

Corrupted Creatures

Blighted Owlbear *Large monstrosity, chaotic evil*

- **Armor Class** 13 (Natural Armor)
- **Hit Points** 59 (7d10 + 21)
- **Speed** 40 ft.
- **STR** 20 (+5) **DEX** 12 (+1) **CON** 17 (+3) **INT** 3 (-4) **WIS** 12 (+1) **CHA** 7 (-2)
- **Skills** Perception +3
- **Damage Resistances** necrotic
- **Senses** darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 13
- **Languages** —
- **Challenge** 3 (700 XP)

Keen Sight and Smell. The owlbear has advantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on sight or smell.

Shadow Corruption. The owlbear's natural weapons count as magical for the purpose of overcoming resistances. Additionally, when the owlbear dies, it releases a burst of shadow energy. All creatures within 10 feet must make a DC 13 Constitution saving throw or take 7 (2d6) necrotic damage.

Actions **Multiattack.** The owlbear makes two attacks: one with its beak and one with its claws.

Beak. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 10 (1d10 + 5) piercing damage.

Claws. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 14 (2d8 + 5) slashing damage.

Encounter: 1 Blighted Owlbear (in the corrupted wilderness areas) **Tactics:** Charges directly into combat, using its corrupted nature to spread the Shadow's influence **Resolution:** Can be purified with powerful restoration magic instead of killed

Corrupted Treant *Huge plant, neutral evil*

- **Armor Class** 16 (Natural Armor)
- **Hit Points** 138 (12d12 + 60)
- **Speed** 30 ft.
- **STR** 23 (+6) **DEX** 8 (-1) **CON** 21 (+5) **INT** 12 (+1) **WIS** 16 (+3) **CHA** 12 (+1)
- **Damage Resistances** bludgeoning, piercing, necrotic
- **Damage Vulnerabilities** fire, radiant
- **Senses** passive Perception 13
- **Languages** Common, Druidic, Elvish, Sylvan
- **Challenge** 9 (5,000 XP)

False Appearance. While the treant remains motionless, it is indistinguishable from a normal tree.

Siege Monster. The treant deals double damage to objects and structures.

Shadow Corruption. The treant's connection to nature has been perverted. Instead of nurturing life, it now spreads decay and despair. Plants within 60 feet of the treant wither and die.

Actions **Multiattack.** The treant makes two slam attacks.

Slam. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +10 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 16 (3d6 + 6) bludgeoning damage plus 7 (2d6) necrotic damage.

Rock. *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +10 to hit, range 60/180 ft., one target. *Hit:* 28 (4d10 + 6) bludgeoning damage.

Animate Trees (1/Day). The treant magically animates one or two trees within 60 feet of it. These trees have the same statistics as a treant, except they have Intelligence and Charisma scores of 1, they can't speak, and they have only the Slam action option. An animated tree acts as an ally of the treant. The tree remains animate for 1 day or until it dies; until the treant dies or is more than 120 feet from the tree; or until the treant takes a bonus action to turn it back into an inanimate tree. The tree then takes root if possible.

Wither (Recharge 5-6). The treant targets all living creatures within 30 feet. Each target must make a DC 17 Constitution saving throw, taking 21 (6d6) necrotic damage on a failed save, or half as much damage on a successful one. Plants automatically fail this saving throw.

Encounter: 1 Corrupted Treant (at Hillhaven, guarding the approach to Finn's prison) **Tactics:** Uses reach and animated trees to control the battlefield while spreading corruption **Resolution:** Can be restored to normal with the *greater restoration* spell and removing the source of corruption

Environmental Challenges

Magical Instability Zones Areas where the Shadow's influence creates wild magic effects.

Challenge: When casting a spell in these areas, roll a d20. On a 1-5, roll on the Wild Magic Surge table (or use a simplified version for lower-level play).

Navigation: Intelligence (Arcana) DC 15 to identify safe paths through the instability.

Mitigation: Characters with magical training can provide advantage on saves for the party.

Temporal Echo Chambers Areas where the past bleeds through, showing visions of the original binding ritual.

Challenge: Wisdom (Perception) DC 14 to distinguish between past and present.

Benefit: Successful observation provides clues about how the binding ritual was performed.

Danger: Characters who fail by 5 or more become temporarily lost in the past vision (stunned for 1 round).

Shadow Corruption Spread Areas where the Shadow's influence actively drains life and energy.

Challenge: Constitution saving throws (DC starts at 10, increases by 1 each round spent in the area).

Effect: Failure results in 1 level of exhaustion that can only be removed by completing a long rest outside the corrupted area.

Protection: Radiant magic or blessed items provide advantage on saves.

The Final Confrontation

The Binding Ritual

When the party reaches the ancient prison, they discover that stopping the Shadow requires more than simple combat. The entity is too powerful to destroy outright, and its prison must be renewed using the same principles as the original binding.

Requirements for Success:

1. **All four captured magic-users must participate willingly**
2. **The party must choose a leader to anchor the ritual**
3. **Significant magical energy must be sacrificed (spell slots, magic items, or life force)**
4. **The ritual must be completed before the Shadow breaks free entirely**

The Choice: The party faces a moral dilemma similar to the ancient heroes:

- **Temporary Solution:** Drive the Shadow back without fully renewing the binding, buying time but leaving the problem for future generations
- **Permanent Solution:** Renew the binding completely, but requiring one of the magic-users to remain as a permanent guardian (like the original sacrifice)
- **Risky Gambit:** Attempt to destroy the Shadow entirely, which could succeed dramatically or fail catastrophically

The Shadow of the Deep (Final Boss)

The Shadow of the Deep *Gargantuan fiend, chaotic evil*

- **Armor Class** 17 (Natural Armor)
- **Hit Points** 200 (16d20 + 32)
- **Speed** 0 ft., fly 60 ft. (hover)
- **STR** 22 (+6) **DEX** 14 (+2) **CON** 15 (+2) **INT** 18 (+4) **WIS** 16 (+3) **CHA** 20 (+5)
- **Saving Throws** Int +9, Wis +8, Cha +10
- **Skills** Arcana +9, Deception +10, Insight +8, Perception +8
- **Damage Resistances** cold, necrotic; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks
- **Damage Immunities** poison
- **Condition Immunities** charmed, exhaustion, frightened, poisoned
- **Senses** truesight 120 ft., passive Perception 18
- **Languages** All languages, telepathy 120 ft.
- **Challenge** 11 (7,200 XP)

Legendary Resistance (3/Day). If the Shadow fails a saving throw, it can choose to succeed instead.

Magic Resistance. The Shadow has advantage on saving throws against spells and other magical effects.

Bound Entity. The Shadow cannot move more than 300 feet from the center of its prison. If the binding ritual is completed successfully, it becomes unable to take actions.

Magical Absorption. When a spell of 3rd level or lower is cast within 60 feet of the Shadow, the Shadow regains 10 hit points.

Spellcasting. The Shadow is an 11th-level spellcaster. Its spellcasting ability is Charisma (spell save DC 18, +10 to hit with spell attacks). It has the following spells prepared:

- **Cantrips (at will):** *eldritch blast, mage hand, minor illusion, prestidigitation*
- **1st level (4 slots):** *charm person, magic missile*
- **2nd level (3 slots):** *darkness, hold person, misty step*
- **3rd level (3 slots):** *counterspell, fireball, hold person*
- **4th level (3 slots):** *confusion, greater invisibility*
- **5th level (2 slots):** *dominate person, scrying*
- **6th level (1 slot):** *circle of death*

Actions *Multiattack.* The Shadow makes three attacks: two with its shadow tendrils and one shadow drain.

Shadow Tendril. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +11 to hit, reach 15 ft., one target. *Hit:* 13 (2d6 + 6) bludgeoning damage plus 7 (2d6) necrotic damage.

Shadow Drain. *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, range 60 ft., one creature. *Hit:* The target must make a DC 18 Constitution saving throw. On a failed save, the target takes 18 (4d8) necrotic damage and the Shadow regains half that amount as hit points. On a successful save, the target takes half damage and the Shadow doesn't regain hit points.

Summon Shadows (Recharge 5-6). The Shadow summons 2d4 shadow spawn in unoccupied spaces within 30 feet. The shadows act on the Shadow's initiative and obey its commands.

Legendary Actions (3 per turn)

- **Move.** The Shadow moves up to its speed without provoking opportunity attacks.
- **Shadow Tendril.** The Shadow makes one shadow tendril attack.
- **Cast Spell (Costs 2 Actions).** The Shadow casts a spell of 3rd level or lower.

Encounter Tactics:

- **Phase 1:** The Shadow fights defensively while trying to corrupt or dominate the rescued magic-users
- **Phase 2:** As its hit points drop, it becomes more aggressive and summons more shadow creatures
- **Phase 3:** When reduced to 50 hit points or below, it attempts to break free of its remaining bonds entirely

Resolution Paths:

- **Combat Victory:** Reduces the Shadow to 0 hit points, forcing it back into dormancy but not solving the underlying problem
- **Ritual Success:** Completing the binding ritual while the Shadow still has hit points remaining, permanently renewing its prison

- **Negotiated Settlement:** Convincing the Shadow to accept a modified prison in exchange for limited influence (very difficult but possible)
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Treasure and Rewards

Magical Items Recovered

Staff of the Ancient Grove Staff, *rare (requires attunement by a druid)* A gnarled wooden staff carved with intricate nature motifs, recovered from the corrupted grove.

- **Property:** +1 to spell attack rolls and spell save DC
- **Charges:** 10 charges, regains 1d6+4 at dawn
- **Spells:** Can cast *entangle* (1 charge), *barkskin* (2 charges), *speak with plants* (3 charges)
- **Special:** When used to cast druid spells that affect plants, the range is doubled

Crystal of Temporal Sight *Wondrous item, uncommon* A clear crystal that swirls with inner light, found in the twins' prison.

- **Property:** Once per day, can cast *augury* without using a spell slot
- **Special:** When held by twins or closely bonded individuals, provides advantage on initiative rolls
- **Lore:** Created by divination magic, it resonates with prophetic abilities

Shadowbane Amulet *Wondrous item, rare* A silver amulet set with a gem that glows with inner radiance.

- **Property:** Resistance to necrotic damage
- **Active Power:** Once per day, can cast *daylight* centered on the wearer
- **Special:** Sheds dim light in a 10-foot radius that counts as sunlight for the purpose of harming undead
- **Origin:** Forged by the original heroes who bound the Shadow

Boots of the Forest Walker *Wondrous item, uncommon* Soft leather boots that seem to be woven from living vines and leaves.

- **Property:** Movement through nonmagical difficult terrain costs no extra movement
- **Special:** Leave no tracks and grant advantage on Stealth checks in natural environments
- **Growth:** The boots gradually adapt to their wearer, eventually allowing limited *tree stride* ability

Experience and Story Rewards

Major Milestones:

- Discovering each captured magic-user's location: 300 XP per character
- Successfully rescuing a magic-user: 400 XP per character
- Uncovering the truth about the Shadow of the Deep: 500 XP per character
- Participating in the binding ritual: 600 XP per character
- Successfully renewing the ancient binding: 800 XP per character

Investigation Successes:

- Solving each village's mystery: 200 XP per character per village
- Discovering crucial historical information: 150 XP per character
- Making allies of the rescued magic-users: 100 XP per character

Roleplay Achievements:

- Convincing frightened villagers to trust the party: 100 XP per character
- Successfully mediating between conflicting viewpoints: 150 XP per character
- Showing mercy to corrupted creatures: 100 XP per character
- Making the difficult choice about the binding ritual's cost: 200 XP per character

Long-Term Consequences

The New Circle: If the adventure succeeds, the rescued magic-users form a new druidic circle dedicated to monitoring and preventing similar threats. This provides:

- **Safe Haven:** A network of allies across the region
- **Information Network:** Early warning about magical threats
- **Training Opportunities:** Access to advanced magical education
- **Moral Support:** A community of like-minded individuals committed to responsible magic use

Regional Changes: The adventure's resolution affects the entire area:

- **Magical Acceptance:** Communities become more welcoming to magic-users
- **Improved Defenses:** Better preparation for supernatural threats
- **Historical Knowledge:** Recovery of ancient lore and techniques
- **Environmental Healing:** Gradual restoration of corrupted areas

Character Development: The moral complexity of the adventure provides opportunities for:

- **Leadership Growth:** Characters must make decisions affecting many lives
 - **Magical Understanding:** Deeper appreciation for the responsibility that comes with power
 - **Community Bonds:** Lasting relationships with NPCs and each other
 - **Sacrifice Appreciation:** Understanding that heroism sometimes requires personal cost
-

Appendices

Appendix A: Connecting to "The Whispering Woods"

Character Continuity: Characters from the first adventure should be level 2-3 at the start of this one. Their previous relationships with Lyra, the village, and the forest provide immediate investment in the new crisis.

Reputation Benefits: The party's previous success provides:

- **Trusted Status:** Villagers and officials take their warnings seriously
- **Resource Access:** Better equipment and support from grateful communities
- **Information Network:** Contacts who provide early warning about threats
- **Moral Authority:** People look to them for leadership in crisis situations

Skill Development: The first adventure's focus on investigation and social interaction prepares characters for this adventure's similar challenges at a higher level.

Appendix B: Scaling for Different Levels

For 2nd Level Parties:

- Reduce enemy hit points by 25%
- Provide more NPCs allies during difficult encounters
- Simplify the binding ritual requirements
- Focus more heavily on investigation and less on combat

For 4th Level Parties:

- Increase enemy numbers or add additional abilities
- Include more complex environmental challenges
- Add time pressure elements to create urgency
- Expand the scope to include additional threatened communities

Appendix C: Alternative Endings

The Heroic Sacrifice: One of the party members chooses to become the new guardian of the binding, gaining great power but accepting permanent responsibility.

The Shared Burden: All the young magic-users agree to split the guardian responsibility, creating a circle of watchers who can live normal lives while maintaining the binding.

The Ancient Alliance: The party discovers descendants of the original binding heroes and reunites the bloodlines to renew the magic through heritage rather than sacrifice.

The Shadow's Redemption: Through exceptional roleplay and moral choices, the party convinces the Shadow to accept rehabilitation rather than continued imprisonment.

Appendix D: Campaign Continuation

Future Threats: The Shadow's attempted escape may have attracted attention from other primordial entities or extraplanar forces interested in the weakened bindings.

The New Circle's Missions: The reformed druidic circle provides ongoing adventure opportunities as they work to heal corrupted areas and prevent similar threats.

Political Ramifications: The revelation of ancient threats and the need for magical cooperation could lead to changes in how kingdoms and organizations treat magic-users.

Personal Growth: The rescued magic-users grow in power and influence, potentially becoming major NPCs in future campaigns or even player characters in their own right.

Designer's Notes

This sequel adventure builds directly on the themes and relationships established in "The Whispering Woods" while escalating the stakes and complexity appropriate for characters who have gained experience and confidence. The focus remains on investigation, moral choices, and the responsible use of power, but with greater scope and more challenging decisions.

The adventure structure allows for significant player agency in how they approach each location and challenge, while the binding ritual provides multiple possible resolutions that reflect different philosophical approaches to heroism and sacrifice.

The Shadow of the Deep serves as a threat that cannot be simply defeated through combat, requiring players to engage with the adventure's deeper themes about the cost of protecting others and the responsibility that comes with magical power.

Estimated Play Time: 4-5 sessions of 4-5 hours each **Party Composition:** Benefits from diverse skills and approaches, rewards characters who developed social and investigation abilities in the first adventure **Difficulty:** Moderate to challenging, with emphasis on creative problem-solving and moral complexity over pure combat optimization

End of Adventure